

With over a decade of experience in supervising and managing type design projects, organising communities, curating cultural knowledge exchanges and multitude of art and media production projects, I am versatile thought leader and a builder focused on Lanak identity and South Asian knowledge and culture.

Interests

- Encoding, fonts and typography of South Asian writing systems
- AI, design and education
- Decolonisation and national identities

Scripts engaged

Latin, Sinhala, Tamil,
Thaana, Thai

Technical proficiency

- Font engineering and Encoding
- AI for Design and Culture

Research areas

- Multiscript typography
- Language as infrastructure
- Cultural exports and design
- Nation building and design

Educational qualifications

- 2016** MA Typeface Design (2015–2016), University of Reading, UK
Graduated with Distinction
- 2013** BA (Hons) in Graphic Design (2010–2013), Academy of Design Colombo
Northumbria University, UK
Graduated with First class, Valedictorian

Professional experience

- 2017–** Director, Mooniak (Managing partner)
Running typography and type design consultancy service
- 2025–** Visiting lecturer on design at the University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka
- 2017–** Visiting lecturer on typography at the Academy of Design, Colombo
- 2015** Faculty member at CraftingType.com on South Asian Scripts
- 2014** Font engineer, Rossetta Type Foundry (Part time - Oct 2016–January 2017)
- 2013** Consultant to Google Fonts (Contract - April 2014–July 2015)
Leading Google Fonts Sinhala web font development with an international team that included Latin, Tamil and Sinhala type designers, font engineers and software engineers, and spanned type design, font engineering, software development of build processes and substantial contributions to open source font editor applications.
- 2013** Junior Art Director, Grant McCann McCann Worldwide, Sri Lanka
(Full time - Oct 2013–April 2014)
- 2013** Teaching Assistant-Graphic Design, Academy of Design, Sri Lanka
(Full time - June 2013–Sep 2014)

Organisations and contributions

Director of Institute of Typography

Developing latest update to the Sri Lanka Standard for Information Interchange

Contributions to Unicode Standard (December 2017–)

Member of Lanka Local Languages Working Group currently collaborating with Unicode editors on rewriting Unicode Standard Core Specification for Sinhala.

GNU GPL font licensing (December 2017–April 2018)

Advising Free Software Foundation on font exception in GNU General Public License and font embedding related technologies in PDF files.

Hanthana Linux (December 2017–April 2018)

Notable technical projects

SLS 1134: Fourth Revision draft (January 2025–)

Developing latest update to the Sri Lanka Standard for Information Interchange.

Contributions to Unicode Standard (December 2017–)

Member of Lanka Local Languages Working Group currently collaborating with Unicode editors on rewriting Unicode Standard Core Specification for Sinhala.

Sinhala Generation Panel - ICANN (December 2017–April 2018)

Member of the Sinhala Generation Panel for Root Zone Sinhala Label Generation Rules (SinhalaGP)

GNU GPL font licensing (December 2017–April 2018)

Advising Free Software Foundation on font exception in GNU General Public License and font embedding related technologies in PDF files.

Contributions to Fontforge (2014–2018)

Maintained the issue tracker and contributed to major revamp of UI. Updated the website and documentation.

Unified Font Repository and related projects (2019–)

Contributions to various font packaging standards and open source projects for font distribution.